

Epiphany

January 4, 2026

THE SAVIOR REVEALED TO THE WORLD

Lamb of God Lutheran Church

599 E. Chandler Blvd., Phoenix, AZ 85048

MyLambofGod.org

WELCOME

Thank you for joining us for worship this morning, whether in-person or online. In our service we gather before our almighty God to offer him our worship and praise. We also gather to strengthen ourselves through the study of God's holy and powerful Word.

PASTOR'S OFFICE HOURS

If you would like to meet with Pastor Koepke, please contact him to make an appointment. Our pastor is here to serve both Lamb of God members and our community.

CHILDREN'S ROOM

We love having children in our service. However, if you feel your child needs to be taken out for a while, you may choose to use the children's room off the hallway near the mailboxes. We also ask everyone to reserve the back few rows for families with young children, making it easier to leave the church area if needed.

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† The Gathering †

OPENING HYMN: Angels from the Realms of Glory (CW 80)

1. Angels from the realms of glory, wing your flight o'er all the earth; Once you sang creation's story; now proclaim Messiah's birth: Come and worship, come and worship, worship Christ, the newborn King.
2. Shepherds, in the fields abiding, watching o'er your flocks by night, God with us is now residing – yonder shines the infant light. Come and worship, come and worship, worship Christ, the newborn King.
3. Magi, leave your contemplations; brighter visions beam afar. Seek the great desire of nations; you have seen the Savior's star. Come and worship, come and worship, worship Christ, the newborn King.
4. Saints before the altar bending, watching long in hope and fear, Suddenly the Lord, descending, in his temple shall appear. Come and worship, come and worship, worship Christ, the newborn King.

INVOCATION

M: The grace of our Lord Jesus Christ and the love of God and the fellowship of the Holy Spirit be with you.

C: And also with you.

PRAYER

M: God of all time, we praise and adore you for breaking into the darkness of this world with the glorious light of your presence, a light which made your love for the world visible in the babe born in Bethlehem, a light which guided those gift-bearing travelers from afar to find and worship the Christ-child, and a light which leads us to you, now revealed in Jesus Christ. We pray that you will accept our worship, for it arises from hearts and minds in awe of the enormity of your gift of love to us. In Jesus' name we pray.

C: Amen.

CONFESSION OF SINS

M: Let us admit to God the sin which always confronts us.

C: Lord God, we have sinned against you; we have done evil in your sight. We are sorry and repent. Have mercy on us according to your love. Wash away our wrongdoing and cleanse us from our sin. Renew a right spirit within us and restore to us the joy of your salvation, through Jesus Christ our Lord. Amen.

M: In the mercy of almighty God, Jesus Christ was given to die for us, and for his sake God forgives us all our sins.

C: Amen.

RESPONSE: What Star Is This

After a musical introduction the congregation sings.

PRAYER OF THE DAY

M: Lord God, by the leading of a star, you once made known to the nations your one and only Son. Guide us, also, who know him now by faith to come at last to the perfect joy of your heavenly glory; through your Son, Jesus Christ our Lord, who lives and reigns with you and the Holy Spirit, one God, now and forever.

C: Amen.

† The Word †

FIRST READING: Isaiah 60:1-6

The prophet foretold that one born king of the Jews would draw kings from distant nations to the light of his glory.

- 1 "Arise, shine, for your light has come, and the glory of the Lord rises upon you.
- 2 See, darkness covers the earth and thick darkness is over the peoples, but the Lord rises upon you and his glory appears over you.
- 3 Nations will come to your light, and kings to the brightness of your dawn.
- 4 Lift up your eyes and look about you: All assemble and come to you; your sons come from afar, and your daughters are carried on the hip.
- 5 Then you will look and be radiant, your heart will throb and swell with joy; the wealth on the seas will be brought to you, to you the riches of the nations will come.
- 6 Herds of camels will cover your land, young camels of Midian and Ephah. And all from Sheba will come, bearing gold and incense and proclaiming the praise of the Lord.

HYMN: Rise Up and Shine (CW21 376)

1. Rise up and shine! Your light has come; God's glory breaks like dawn. For though the earth be cloaked in night and gloom shrouds ev'ryone, Yet over you the Lord will rise, with glory gleaming clear, Till nations turn to seek your light and humbled kings draw near.
2. Fling wide your gates, both day and night; no more keep watch or guard. You will be called God's holy hill, the city of the Lord. No sound of strife will plague your land, nor harm besiege your ways; "Salvation" will you name your walls, and all your portals "Praise."
3. No more will you implore the sun to shed by day its light, Nor will you need the changeful moon to glisten through the night. Your glory then will be your God, whose light will never cease. Rise up and shine! Your light has come to give you joy and peace.

CHILDREN'S MESSAGE

GOSPEL READING: Matthew 2:1-12

Magi from the east were the first in a long line of Gentiles who would join Israel in worshipping Jesus as King.

After Jesus was born in Bethlehem in Judea, during the time of King Herod, Magi from the east came to Jerusalem and asked, "Where is the one who has been born king of the Jews? We saw his star when it rose and have come to worship him."

When King Herod heard this he was disturbed, and all Jerusalem with him. When he had called together all the people's chief priests and teachers of the law, he asked them where the Messiah was to be born. "In Bethlehem in Judea," they replied.

After they had heard the king, they went on their way, and the star they had seen when it rose went ahead of them until it stopped over the place where the child was. When they saw the star, they were overjoyed.

HYMN OF THE DAY: How Lovely Shines the Morning Star (CW 79 v. 1, 3, 5)

1. How lovely shines the Morning Star! The nations see and hail afar the light in Judah shining.
2. O mighty Father, in your Son you loved me ere you had begun this ancient world's foundation.
3. Lift up the voice and strike the string, let all glad sounds of music ring in God's high praises blended.

SERMON: Ephesians 3:2-12

The mystery of Christ revealed to the Gentiles.

This mystery is that through the gospel the Gentiles are heirs together with Israel, members together of one body, and sharers together in the promise in Christ Jesus.

In him and through faith in him we may approach God with freedom and confidence.

CONFESSION OF FAITH: APOSTLES' CREED

I believe in God, the Father almighty, maker of heaven and earth.

I believe in Jesus Christ, his only Son, our Lord, who was conceived by the Holy Spirit, born of the virgin Mary, suffered under Pontius Pilate, was crucified, died, and was buried. He descended into hell. The third day he rose again from the dead. He ascended into heaven and is seated at the right hand of God the Father almighty. From there he will come to judge the living and the dead.

I believe in the Holy Spirit, the holy Christian Church, the communion of saints, the forgiveness of sins, the resurrection of the body, and the life everlasting. Amen.

† The Prayers †

PRAYER OF THE CHURCH

M: Lord Jesus Christ, Son of God and Mary's son, in the fullness of time you came into our world to save us from sin and death:

C: You ushered in the day of grace so long foretold.

M: Beloved Son of the Father, revered by the Magi, baptized by John, you came preaching and teaching, healing and comforting, forgiving and encouraging:

C: You brought the light of life to those walking in darkness, and the joy of salvation to those doomed to death.

M: Prince of Peace, shine like the sunrise for us and the people of our world. Let the good news of salvation be heard in the remotest corners of the earth.

C: Arouse us and our missionaries to flood the world with the light of your gospel.

Special prayers and petitions may be offered.

M: Hear us, Lord, as we bring you our private petitions.

Silent prayer.

THE LORD'S PRAYER

C: Our Father in heaven, hallowed be your name, your kingdom come, your will be done on earth as in heaven. Give us today our daily bread. Forgive us our sins, as we forgive those who sin against us. Lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil. For the kingdom, the power, and the glory are yours now and forever. Amen.

THE LORD'S BLESSING

M: Brothers and sisters, go in peace. Live in harmony with one another. Serve the Lord with gladness.

M: The Lord bless you and keep you. The Lord make his face shine on you and be gracious to you. The Lord look on you with favor and give you peace.

C: Amen.

CLOSING HYMN: As With Gladness Men of Old (CW 83)

1. As with gladness men of old did the guiding star behold, as with joy they hailed its light, leading onward, beaming bright, so, most gracious Lord, may we evermore your followers be.
2. As with joyful steps they sped, Savior, to your lowly bed, there to bend the knee before you whom heaven and earth adore, so may we with willing feet ever seek your mercy seat.
3. Holy Jesus, every day keep us in the narrow way; and, when earthly things are past, bring our ransomed souls at last where they need no star to guide, where no clouds your glory hide.

ANNOUNCEMENTS

BIBLE CLASSES

- Children's Sunday School — Children meet at the front of church at 10:45am on Sundays after our service and fellowship.
- Sunday Bible Class — After the children's lesson, there is a 19-minute study.
- Foundations Class begins in January.

MEN OF HIS WORD CONFERENCE

Men: You're invited to the 2026 Men of His Word Conference on Saturday, January 31, 2026 at Desert Willow Conference Center. Visit menofhisword.org for more information and to register.

SUNDAY FELLOWSHIP HOSTING

Thank you to all who have helped with our fellowship hosting this year by making coffee, setting out refreshments and cleaning up. Please consider taking your turn in the next few months.

SATURDAY CLEAN UP DAY

We will have a cleanup day on Saturday, January 10 to take down Christmas decorations. All are welcome to help, starting at 8:30am.

GIVING TO LAMB OF GOD

If you wish to give your offering to Lamb of God online, this QR code is provided for your convenience. Several types of payment are accepted on this secure site.



LIFE GROUPS

The Winter/Spring session of our Life Groups will begin in January. You may pick up a pamphlet on the church welcome table or check out the groups below and see where you can be involved.

WOMEN'S BIBLE STUDY

There will be a six-session study for women of First and Second Kings using the book *Trustworthy: Overcoming Our Greatest Struggles to Trust God* by Lysa Terkeurst.

FAITH & FLAVOR

Faith & Flavor brings the Lamb of God church family together once a month for themed meals inspired by different cuisines and traditions.

REQUESTS FOR PRAYER AND CARE

Your prayer request will be treated with great discretion and shared with a limited group of prayer warriors who will consider it a gift to cover you in prayer. This is also a way to reach the Caring Committee if you need other assistance.

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